

SESSION 01 — MAY 8, 2026

Designing the Fitler MBA

F

A practitioner's program, twenty sessions, one cohort.

• SCOTT SILL, FOUNDER • TWENTY SESSIONS · FIVE MONTHS • THE BACK BAR · 6:00 PM

“

*Whatever you can do, or
dream you can, begin it.
Boldness has genius, power,
and magic in it.*

– ATTRIBUTED TO GOETHE

A QUESTION WORTH ANSWERING OUT LOUD

Why are *you* here?

i. Career advancement

Add a new gear to what you already do well.

ii. Career change

Re-platform your professional identity.

iii. Start a new business

Make the leap with frameworks, not vibes.

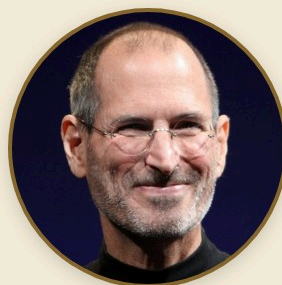
iv. Change the world

Yes, really. Why else are we doing this?

Hmmm...



Bill Gates



Steve Jobs



Michael Dell



Mark Zuckerberg

*An MBA isn't a requirement for
leadership.*
The thinking is.

Same *moment*. New century.

- 1881

Joseph Wharton founds the first collegiate business school. The economy is moving from agrarian to industrial — and the country needs a new kind of leader. Stable systems require execution. New systems require search.

- 2026

The economy is moving from industrial knowledge work to AI-augmented everything. Yesterday's playbook was built for executing known business models. The work in front of us is search, not execution.

The Fitler MBA is built for this moment.

Not "learn what we already know." Not a degree to add to your wall. A practitioner's program for searching faster than anyone else in your market — with AI in the room every session.

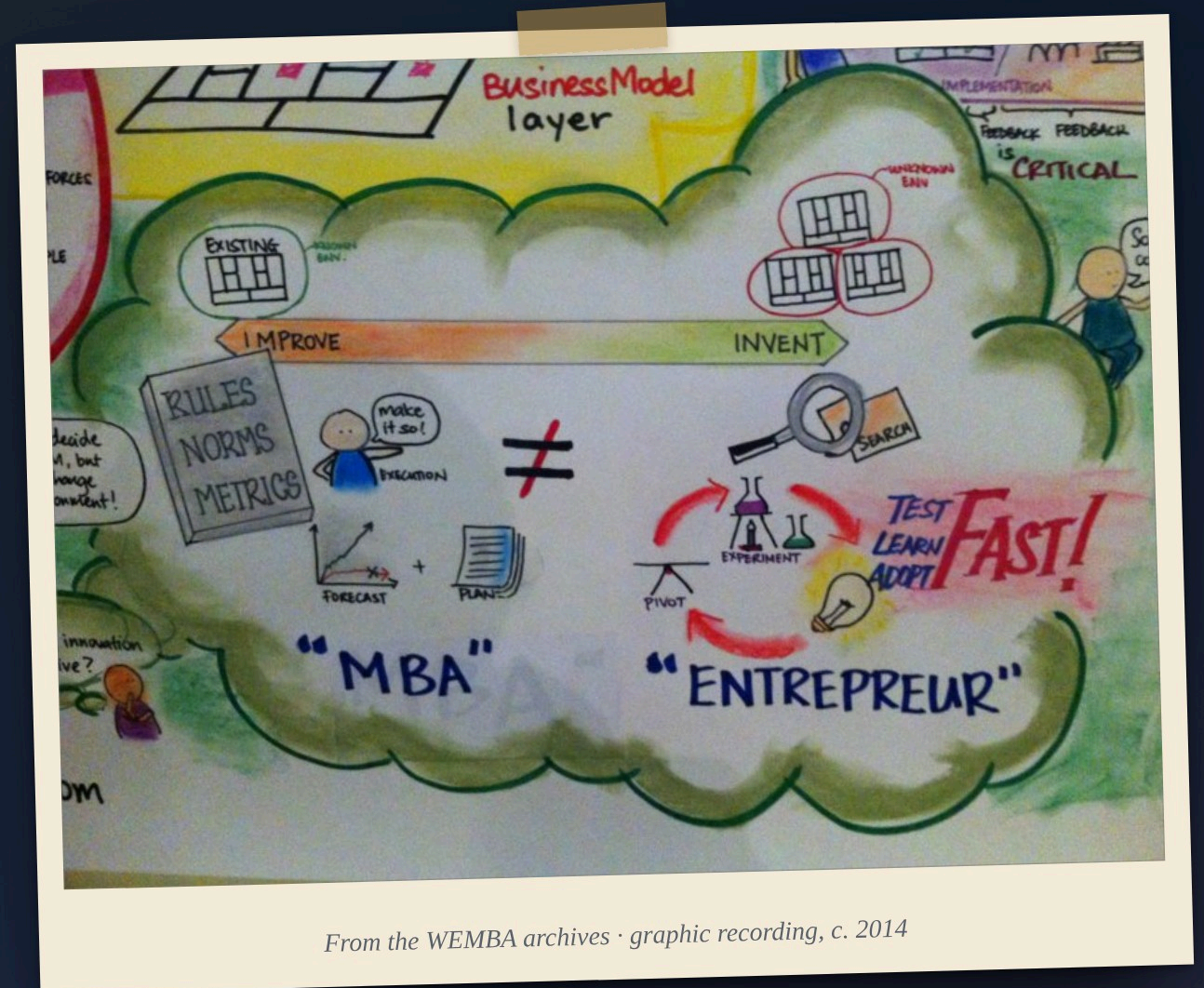
If Wharton was the answer to 1881, this is part of the answer to 2026.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Two different muscles.

A graphic recorder sketched this during a Wharton session years ago. It still nails what most MBAs aren't built to teach: the right-hand side. Rules and forecasts get you good execution. Search and experiment get you new businesses.

The Fitler MBA is built around the right half of this drawing — and AI is the multiplier that makes it possible.



From the WEMBA archives · graphic recording, c. 2014

"MBA" MUSCLE

Rules, norms, metrics

Execution

Forecast + plan

Improve what exists

"ENTREPRENEUR" MUSCLE

Search

Experiment + pivot

Test, learn, adopt *fast*

Invent what doesn't

FOR THE RECORD

This is *not* a Wharton program.

The Fitler MBA borrows methodology from accelerators and academic rigor from top business schools. It is built for Fitler Club members, by practitioners, and is not endorsed by, affiliated with, or operated by The Wharton School.

What we'll *build* together.

FROM MINDSET TO MOATS. EACH SESSION 60–90 MINUTES, INTERACTIVE, WITH AI IN EVERY CHAPTER.



01
Entrepreneurial Mindset



02
Problem-Solution Fit



03
Business Model Innovation



04
Financial Foundations



05
Time Value of Money



06
Customer Discovery



07
Product & MVP Strategy



08
Pricing & Revenue



09
Go-to-Market



10
Competitive Strategy



11
Building Your Team



12
Investors & Capital



13
Fundraising Execution



14
Legal Foundations



15
Pitching & Storytelling



16
Cap Tables & Structure



Who's in the *room*?

PROMPT

"Your name, what you do, and one problem you wish someone would solve."

- 30 SECONDS EACH — STRICT
- PICK A PROBLEM YOU'D ACTUALLY PAY TO SOLVE
- POST IT IN #PROBLEMS ON DISCORD AS YOU SPEAK
- WE'LL COME BACK TO THREE OF THESE TONIGHT

THE COHORT — 24 STRONG

Nusaybah Jackson

BHHS Fox & Roach · Real Estate

Brooke Hayes

Lineage Merchant Partners · Finance

Matt Hickerson

LL Funds · Finance

Sam Kimelman

8AM Creative · Marketing

Kate Berglund

Center for Humane Technology

John Riley

Dow · R&D

Kyleem Myers

CHOP · Healthcare

Alexandra Janelli

Burple · Tech

Drew Smith

Render · Tech

Arpit Kaul

Medrina · Healthcare

Adrien Griffin

Perpay · Finance

Jared Gold

Huron · Consulting

Mike Goldstein

HubKey · Real Estate

Steven Farrell

Fishtown Creative

Stephanie Ellis

Compass · Real Estate

Anthony D'Alicandro

Compass · Real Estate

Eric White

Vanguard · Finance

Meghan Lopes

Speakcore · Marketing

Max Raiken

Philly Youth Basketball

Jigar Mehta

Consulting

Catherine Price

Author, Journalist, Speaker

Brandy Davila

Salon Tenshi · Wellness

William Kirkpatrick

Total Access Medical

Alec Jachwak

ShareVault · Tech



Ten *minutes*.

Refill. Trade cards. We come back ready to play
with AI.

The *tools* we'll use.

i.

Claude

Long thinking, writing, code, document review.
Our primary daily driver.

REASONING · WRITING

ii.

ChatGPT

Second opinion, image generation, voice
mode. Good to keep in rotation.

COMPARISON · MULTIMODAL

iii.

Google NotebookLM

Drop documents in, ask questions, generate
audio briefings. The research room.

RESEARCH · SOURCE-GROUNDED

iv.

Perplexity / Comet

Live web answers with citations. When you
need the freshest fact.

SEARCH · CITATIONS

v.

Agentic Browsers

OpenClaw, Hermes — AI that drives the
browser for you. The frontier.

AGENTS · AUTOMATION

vi.

Claude Design + Console

The Anthropic developer surface. Where we'll
do live prompt engineering tonight.

BUILDERS · LIVE DEMO

Write a *brief*, not a wish.

Treat every prompt as the brief you'd give a sharp new analyst on day one.
Five blocks. In any order. Memorize this.

LETTER	ELEMENT	WHAT TO INCLUDE
<i>R</i>	Role	Who is the AI being right now? "You are a contract lawyer." "You are Steve Blank coaching a founder."
<i>T</i>	Task	The specific action. Affirmative ("do this"), not negative ("don't do that"). Specific beats clever.
<i>C</i>	Context	Background, audience, constraints, source material. The brief you'd give a new analyst.
<i>E</i>	Examples	Three to five examples of input → desired output. Claude reads examples literally — they steer the answer.
<i>F</i>	Format	Exact output shape. Numbered list? JSON? 200 words? Don't make the model guess.

Two *power moves*.

MOVE I — MAKE IT INTERVIEW YOU

01

"Before you respond, ask me any questions that would help you produce a better answer."

Forces the model to surface its assumptions. You'll get questions back that reveal gaps in your own thinking. Use it before any high-stakes output.

MOVE II — MAKE IT GRADE ITSELF

02

"Now be a critical reviewer and rate that response 1–10. Iterate until it scores a 9.5 or better."

Self-critique trades a few seconds of compute for substantially better output. Models are harsher critics than they are first-pass writers.

A wish vs. a brief.

Same task. Two prompts. The difference in output is enormous — and it's not because the model got smarter between them.

x WISH

"Help me write a marketing email for my new product."

What you get: a generic email anyone could have written. Vague headline. Polite CTA. Smells like AI. Goes to spam.

✓ BRIEF (RTCEF)

R *You're a direct-response copywriter in the style of Joanna Wiebe.*

T *Write a 120-word email announcing our launch.*

C *Audience: founders who already follow me on LinkedIn. They know the problem.*

E *Subject line must feel like a text from a friend, not a press release.*

F *One CTA. No emojis. Plain text. Reply-to-me energy.*

What you get: a punchy email with a specific voice, audience awareness, and a single clear ask. Reads human. Earns the click.

LIVE · RIGHT NOW · TOGETHER

Let's run a *real* one.

CLAUDE · RTCEF LIVE DEMO

ROLE	You're a <i>customer discovery coach</i> trained on Steve Blank's methodology.
TASK	Help me find ten people I should interview about the problem on the next line.
CONTEXT	The problem is [<i>a problem from tonight's intros</i>]. I have zero traction and want to validate before I build anything.
EXAMPLES	Good interviewee: someone who has tried to solve this in the last 90 days. Bad interviewee: someone who agrees the problem exists but hasn't acted on it.
FORMAT	Numbered list. Role, where to find them, one question to ask them. No preamble.

Then we add Power Move I, and watch Claude interview us first.

5

MINUTES

Now *you* drive.

i.

Turn to the person next to you. Trade problems.

ii.

Open Claude. Write an RTCEF prompt for *their* problem, not yours.

iii.

Run it. Add Power Move II ("rate yourself 1–10"). Iterate once.

iv.

Post your best output in #show-your-work on Discord.

The *room* is the curriculum.

The night before my Micro midterm at Wharton, I had a meltdown. My cohort got me through it. Twenty-five years later I'm still in touch with most of them.

— SCOTT, ON WHAT A COHORT IS FOR

24

Founders, operators, and senior leaders in this room — across 10 industries.

24/7

Discord engagement between sessions. Where the real compounding happens.

∞

Introductions, referrals, customers, and co-founders that will surface here.

Three problems we'll *workshop* next week.

By Session 2, I'll have picked three problems from the #problems channel — the ones with the biggest "I'd pay to solve this" energy — and we'll run them through customer discovery live.

PROBLEM 01 — TBD TONIGHT

" ____ "

Whose problem? We'll find out from the room.
Bring your two-cents on Discord this week.

PROBLEM 02 — TBD TONIGHT

" ____ "

Cross-industry insights wanted. Most
problems are solved by people who don't
share the language.

PROBLEM 03 — TBD TONIGHT

" ____ "

If you have customers like this in your
network, raise your hand. Intros are the
unlock.

Three things, *specific* deadlines.

i. Join Discord. Post the problem you named tonight.

Drop your "one problem" in #problems. Then read at least five others and reply to two with a question, a referral, or a contrarian take. This is how the cohort starts compounding.

DUE · FRIDAY 11:59 PM

ii. Write a Forbes article — about yourself, dated 2036.

Three to five paragraphs. What did you build? Who did it help? Write as if it has already happened. Use Claude with RTCEF and both power moves. Bring the result to Session 2 — three of you will read yours.

DUE · SESSION 02

iii. Run one RTCEF prompt on a real problem from your work week.

Not a Fitler MBA problem — something on your actual desk. Post the before/after in #show-your-work. We'll workshop the best one live next session.

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See you next week. Bring something bold.